

To: Eclipse Catering
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Sanity Document Retention — Findings & Recommendations

CaterFlow production dataset (Sanity project v3sfsml, dataset "production")

This report covers an audit of CaterFlow's 60-day document retention policy in Sanity: why documents are visibly present past their intended retention window, and whether the retention/deletion logic itself is working correctly.

Short answer: the retention design is correct and verified end-to-end. The documents currently overdue are explained by two ordinary, self-resolving mechanics detailed below — not by a fault in the system.

TOTAL DOCUMENTS	OVERDUE BY BUSINESS DATE	ELIGIBLE FOR DELETION NOW
30,948	11,946	558

Summary

The retention design and deletion logic were audited directly against the production dataset and found to be correct. Documents remain past their 60-day retention cutoff for two compounding, self-resolving reasons — neither of which is a stalled process:

- **Archival timing.** A document only becomes eligible for deletion 60 days after it was copied into the archive database, not 60 days after its own business date. A backlog earlier this year means a meaningful share of older documents were only archived very recently, resetting their effective countdown.
- **Reference integrity.** Of the documents that have cleared the archival-timing gate, almost all are PurchaseOrders still linked to a GoodsReceipt that hasn't itself aged out yet. Sanity correctly refuses to delete a document that something else still references — this is the retention system working as designed, not a bug.

Evidence the Retention Design Is Correct

- **No orphaned documents anywhere.** Every reference field across the entire dataset was scanned — all documents, roughly 510,000 individual reference fields — and zero point at a non-existent document. Sanity's reference model blocks any delete that would create a dangling reference, so this is structurally guaranteed, not just observed today.
- **File cleanup is complete and correct.** Every attached-file record resolves to a live parent document, and every underlying file (image/PDF) is referenced by exactly one record — no orphaned metadata, no unused files left behind.
- **Deletion ordering is correct.** Records are removed child-before-parent (attachments and snapshots before the purchase orders, receipts, and dispatch logs that own them), and a stale-reference issue identified in an earlier pass has been fixed and verified in production.

What's Actually Keeping Documents Around

1. Archival timing delays the deletion clock

A document only becomes eligible for permanent deletion 60 days after it was copied into the archive database — not 60 days after its own business date. Archiving itself ran badly behind schedule for several months: one PurchaseOrder dated 10 December 2025 wasn't copied into the archive database until 8 September 2026, nearly nine months later, with large batches only catching up on a handful of specific days (1,855 PurchaseOrders alone were archived in a single day on 8 September). Every document caught in that backlog now has to wait a fresh 60 days from its late archive date, regardless of how overdue it already was by business date. For PurchaseOrders alone, 1,684 documents are overdue by business date but were archived too recently to be considered for deletion yet.

2. Reference-order blocking (expected behavior, not a defect)

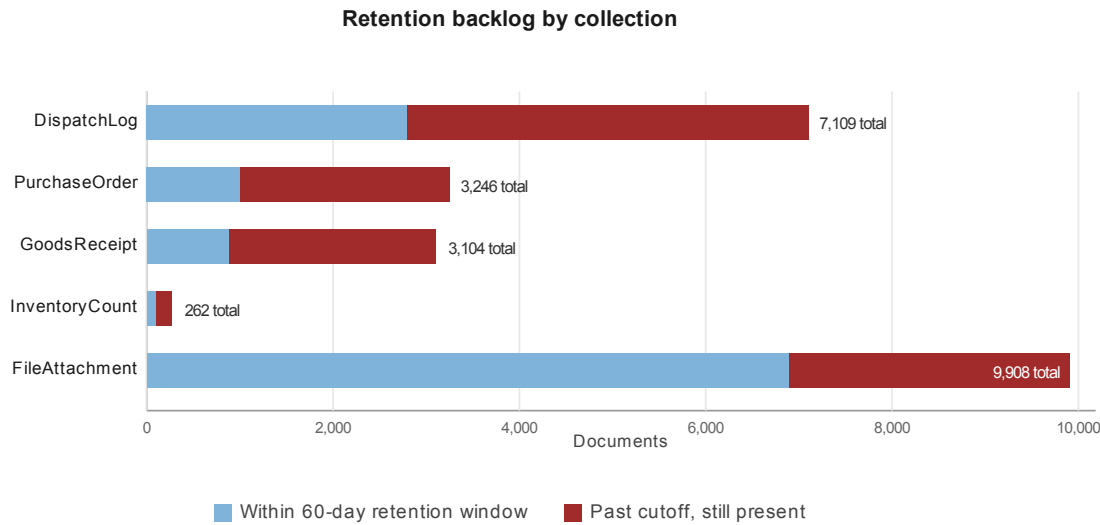
Of the 558 documents that have cleared the archival-timing gate right now — almost all PurchaseOrders — the system has correctly deleted zero of them so far, with zero errors logged. Sanity's own reference-integrity check is silently and correctly skipping each one, because the GoodsReceipt that fulfilled it hasn't individually crossed its own cutoff yet (zero GoodsReceipts are currently past cutoff). This is handled as expected steady-state behavior and retries automatically on every pass. It resolves on its own as GoodsReceipts age out; we recommend against forcing these deletions through ahead of that, as it would leave live GoodsReceipt records pointing at PurchaseOrders that no longer exist.

Also addressed during this review

A related issue was found and fixed in the admin tooling: the "clear lock" endpoint used to reset a stuck archive/cleanup process only ever reset one of two separate lock records, meaning a genuinely stuck cleanup process could not have been cleared through it. This has been extended to reset either or both. Neither lock is currently stuck in production — this was a preventive fix, not a repair for an active incident.

Retention Backlog by Collection

Documents that should already be gone under the 60-day retention policy are still present. This is a snapshot of what's overdue by business date right now, broken down by record type.



Date range detail

Collection	Total Docs	Oldest Record	Newest Record	Overdue (Business Date)	% Overdue
DispatchLog	7,109	2025-12-08	2026-09-19	4,308	61%
PurchaseOrder	3,246	2025-12-10	2026-09-19	2,244	69%
GoodsReceipt	3,104	2025-12-10	2026-09-19	2,219	71%
InventoryCount	262	2025-12-08	2026-09-19	166	63%
FileAttachment	9,908	2026-06-29	2026-09-19	3,009	30%
TOTAL	23,629			11,946	51%

"Overdue (business date)" counts only records in a finished workflow status (completed/cancelled/adjusted) whose business date is older than the 60-day cutoff (2026-07-24) — records the system's own rules already say are safe to remove. It excludes records still in draft/pending status, which are correctly retained regardless of age, and one DispatchLog record carrying a corrupted far-future date (a data-entry error, not a retention issue). Of these 11,946, only 558 have also cleared the archival-timing gate described above — the rest are correctly retained until their own copy into the archive database is itself 60 days old.

Recommended Next Steps

- **No manual intervention needed on the pipeline itself.** It is running normally and will keep working through this backlog as GoodsReceipts age out and the archival-timing backlog catches up.
- **Investigate why PurchaseOrders from December 2025 weren't copied into the archive database until September 2026.** If that lag recurs for currently-fresh documents, it will keep re-extending their effective retention well past the intended 60 days.
- **Confirm the intended retention period with whoever owns this policy, then set it explicitly in the production environment configuration** rather than relying on a code default — this removes any risk of the running system quietly using a different cutoff than intended.
- **Do not force-delete PurchaseOrders past Sanity's reference-integrity check.** Doing so would leave live GoodsReceipt records referencing deleted PurchaseOrders and should be avoided.

Note on document volume

Sanity's published plan tiers are 10,000 documents on the Free plan, 50,000 on Growth, and 1,000,000+ on Enterprise. At 30,948 documents and still writing new ones without being blocked, this project is on the Growth tier or higher — current

usage sits at roughly 62% of a 50,000-document quota, comfortably within limit. This should still be confirmed directly against the Sanity account's billing page, but it is not an area of concern at current volume.